OFFICIAL PRODUCT DOCUMENTATION

Full Platform & Plan Comparison Guide

A complete architectural breakdown of **Online (Cloud Web)**, **Offline Desktop (Windows & Mac)**, and the **Android Tablet Offline APK**. Choose the ideal deployment model for your photo studio, wedding photobooth, or pop-up receipt booth.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & KEY INNOVATIONS AT A GLANCE

- ✓ **100% Offline Capability:** Desktop & Android run without internet at the venue.
- ✓ **Thermal Receipt Printing:** Full Bluetooth & USB support for 58mm & 80mm low-cost receipt booths.
- ✓ **Local Share Web Server:** Guests scan QR over local Wi-Fi to save photos straight from the device.
- ✓ **Direct USB DSLR Control:** Native shutter, flash sync, and live view on Canon, Nikon, Sony.
- ✓ **Virtual Assistant Voice:** Spoken pose countdowns ("3, 2, 1... Smile!") in English & Tagalog.
- ✓ **360 Video Desk (Beta):** Complete slow-mo, boomerang, and 40 animated Spin-FX overlays.

The Three Platforms Explained

WEB / CLOUD PLATFORM

🌐 Online Booth

Runs in any modern browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge) on PC, Mac, iPad, or Phone

- **Zero Installation:** Open URL, log in with access code, and begin shooting instantly.
- **PayMongo QR Payments:** Collect payments via GCash, Maya, ShopeePay before shooting.
- **Google Drive Auto-Sync:** Automatic cloud backup of all photos and animated GIFs.
- **7-Day Online Gallery:** Public event links for guests to view everyone's photos.
- **Requirement:** Requires an active, dependable venue Wi-Fi or cellular data connection.

Best for: Studios with Wi-Fi & iPad kiosks

STANDALONE NATIVE APP

💻 Desktop (Win/Mac)

Windows 10/11 or macOS (Apple Silicon & Intel) installable software

- **100% True Offline:** Needs internet once to activate; zero internet needed at events.
- **USB DSLR & Mirrorless:** Direct PTP hardware shutter & flash sync (Canon, Nikon, Sony).
- **Silent Spooler Printing:** Auto-route 2x6 strips and 4R postcards to dye-sub printers without popups.
- **Built-in Booth Hotspot:** Windows laptop can host its own Wi-Fi with no router or internet.
- **Dual-Display Guest Screen:** Fullscreen live viewfinder on second TV/monitor via HDMI.

Best for: Pro event rentals, weddings, & high volume

NATIVE TABLET KIOSK

📱 Android APK

Dedicated APK for Android tablets (Samsung Tab, Lenovo, Pixel, API 24+)

- **Bluetooth Thermal Receipt:** Direct RFCOMM SPP bridge for 58mm & 80mm ESC/POS printers.
- **Event Kiosk Mode:** Sticky fullscreen, screen keep-awake, and back-button lock protection.
- **Wi-Fi Direct Hosting:** Tablet creates its own local offline Wi-Fi for guest QR downloads.
- **USB OTG Camera Host:** Connects Nikon, Canon, and Sony cameras via USB-C/OTG adapter.
- **Ultra-Portable:** Lightweight, cable-free battery-powered setup for mobile booths.

Best for: Receipt photobooths & mobile tablet stands

🏷️ Introductory Launch Pricing (Special Discount Phase)

SPECIAL LAUNCH OFFER

🌐 Online Plan

₱799 / mo • ₱3,299 Lifetime

Full browser cloud booth, PayMongo GCash/Maya QR payments, Google Drive sync, and online guest galleries.

🔌 Offline Plan

₱999 / mo • ₱3,999 Lifetime

Windows, Mac, and Android offline apps. Zero internet needed, USB DSLR control, local Wi-Fi QR, and silent printing.

🚀 Online + Offline Combo

₱1,299 / mo • ₱4,999 Lifetime

Complete peace of mind. Access both Cloud Web and Offline Desktop + Android apps. Switch seamlessly anytime!

❤️ **Why are Lifetime prices discounted?** We are in active launching mode and value customer feedback above all else. Availing now locks in your lifetime license with free updates forever as new features land. *Check our post comments section to see real customer reviews and implemented requests!*

CORE HARDWARE CAPABILITIES

Cameras, Printers & Offline Networking

Understanding how each platform interfaces with external photography equipment, commercial printing engines, and guest network connections.

DSLR & Mirrorless USB Control (PTP)

Allows the booth software to command the camera's hardware shutter, synchronize external studio strobes/flashes, pull the live viewfinder video stream, and instantly download high-resolution RAW/JPEG captures.

Desktop: Native (No Zadig) | Android: USB-OTG Host | Online: WebUSB (Chrome only)

Supported Camera Brands & Models

- **Canon EOS:** Rebel T3i–T8i, 60D, 70D, 80D, 90D, 7D, 5D Mk III/IV, EOS R, RP, R10, R50, R6.
- **Nikon:** D3200, D3400, D5300, D5600, D7100, D7200, D750, D850, Z50, Zfc, Z5, Z6.
- **Sony Alpha:** A7 III, A7 IV, A6000, A6400, A6600 (Set USB to *PC Remote*).
- **Others (Fujifilm, Lumix, Olympus):** Supported via clean HDMI capture or USB webcam mode.

Canon PTP | Nikon MTP/PTP | Sony PC Remote | HDMI CamLink

macOS Camera Conflict Breaker (camfree)

On macOS, system daemons like `ptpcamerad` and Image Capture automatically hijack plugged-in DSLRs. The Mac desktop app automatically terminates these processes on launch so photobooth4u connects without permission errors.

Mac App Exclusive | Automated Release

Bluetooth & USB Thermal Receipt Printing

Direct hardware printing for trending 58mm and 80mm receipt photobooths. The Android app features a dedicated Kotlin RFCOMM SPP bridge with Floyd-Steinberg dithering and 256-line raster slicing to prevent buffer overflow on low-memory receipt printers.

Android: Direct Bluetooth SPP | Desktop: System Spooler | 58mm / 80mm

Commercial Dye-Sub & Inkjet Printers

- **Dye-Sub Photo Printers:** DNP DS620, RX1HS, HiTi P525L, Citizen CX-02, Sinfonia CS2, Mitsubishi CP-D70DW. (Supported natively on Desktop with zero-dialog silent auto-cut).
- **Portable & Inkjets:** Canon Selphy CP1300/1500, Epson EcoTank L-series, Brother, HP. (Desktop via driver; Android via driverless IPP/Mopria).

Desktop: Multi-Queue Routing | Android: IPP / ESC/P-R

Built-in Local Share Server (Port 47777+)

Both Desktop and Android run a local micro web server. When guests scan the Photo QR, they connect over local Wi-Fi directly to the laptop/tablet: `http://<device-ip>:47777/e/<event>/`. Includes HTTP 206 Range headers so smartphones stream MP4s smoothly without lag.

Desktop Server | Android Server | Zero Data / SIM

Autonomous Wi-Fi Hosting Comparison (No External Router Needed)

How to let guests scan QR codes in venues with no existing Wi-Fi or phone signal:

Windows Desktop: Uses `NetworkOperatorTetheringManager` via PowerShell. Automatically configures Microsoft Loopback adapter and firewall rules to host a local hotspot with *zero internet*.

Android APK: Activates Wi-Fi Direct group (`DIRECT-pb-photobooth4u-...`) at `192.168.49.1` or Local-Only Hotspot. Generates instant Join-Wi-Fi QR for guests.

Mac Desktop & Online: Connects to any portable pocket router or mobile phone hotspot (no cellular data required on the router, just a local network).

EXPERIENCE, CREATIVE & MONETIZATION

Interactive Experience, Design & Payments

From automated voice assistants and roving photographers to cashless PayMongo QR payments and 360 spin desks.

🎙️ Virtual Assistant & Voice Countdown

Interactive synthesized voice prompts that hype up guests and keep the photo queue moving: *"Get ready… Three, Two, One… Smile!"*. Prompts automatically sync with countdown numbers and support English and Tagalog device voices.

Online: Web Speech | Desktop: Native TTS | Android: TextToSpeech API

🚶 Roving Photoman / Photographer Mode

Untether the photographer from the booth! A roving photographer roams the venue, takes pictures with their phone, scans the booth's Roving QR code, and uploads photos over local Wi-Fi. The laptop automatically places them into the event's Canva frame and sends them to the printer.

Desktop Built-in | Local Wi-Fi Upload | Instant Auto-Print

🔒 Lock Photobooth & Kiosk Protection

Prevents guests, curious clients, or kids from messing with booth configurations:

- **Desktop/Online:** Passcode-protected admin settings dock.
- **Android APK:** Immersive sticky full-screen (hides navigation/status bars), screen keep-awake (`FLAG_KEEP_SCREEN_ON`), and back-button interception.

Passcode Lock | Android Kiosk Mode | Unattended Operation

📸 Live Event Gallery & One-Click Reprints

Operators can open the "All Photos" drawer in the bottom bar at any time to review past captures. Tapping any photo reveals an instant **"Print photo"** button to produce extra copies on demand on the designated printer without opening file explorer.

Desktop: Direct Print | Android: Local Gallery | Online: Cloud Drawer

💳 Payments: QR PayMongo vs. Offline Vouchers

- **Online (PayMongo QR):** Dynamic QR codes displayed on screen for GCash, Maya, ShopeePay, and banks. Camera and printing only unlock once the webhook confirms payment.
- **Offline (Single-Use Vouchers):** Sell pre-printed numbered codes at the registration desk. Guests enter code on the booth touch screen to initiate a session.

Online: GCash & Maya | Desktop: Vouchers | Android: Vouchers

🎥 Video Guestbook & Motion Modes

- **Video Guestbook:** Guests record a 5–30 second greeting with microphone sound. Generates an instant Video QR code to download.
- **Animated GIF Mode:** Generates a looping GIF alongside photo strips.
- **Printable Flipbooks:** Decomposes a 6-second clip into 16–40 cards formatted for stack-cut collation with an animated QR on the cover.

Video Guestbook | Animated GIF | Printable Flipbook

🔄 360 Spin Video Desk & FX BETA

Dedicated 360 video management station on the desktop app. Supports phone send portal (`/spin/send`), ffmpeg video processing (0.5x Slow-mo, Speed Ramp, Boomerang forward/back), background music track mixing, transparent event logo overlays, and **40 animated Spin-FX loop overlays** (confetti, light leaks, sparkles, hearts, smoke).

Desktop App | Currently in Beta | ffmpeg Engine

🎨 Layouts, Canva Frames & Vintage Filters

Choose from 12+ built-in aspect ratios (2x6 strips, 4R, single shot, film reels). Upload custom Canva PNG frames with transparent cutouts, add logos and stickers, and apply vintage color grades (Film, Faded, 70s, Instant, Noir, B&W, Sepia) with optional date stamp overlays.

12+ Layouts | Custom Canva | Vintage Filters

FULL FEATURE MATRIX

Side-by-Side Comparison & Recommendations

Feature / Capability	🌐 Online (Cloud Web)	🖥️ Desktop (Win & Mac)	📱 Android APK
ENVIRONMENT & INFRASTRUCTURE			
Venue Internet Requirement	Continuous Online Requires active Wi-Fi/4G	**100% Offline** Activates once, runs offline	**100% Offline** Activates once, runs offline
Local Share Server (Port 47777+)	❌ No Uses Netlify cloud links	✅ **Yes** Embedded Node HTTP server	✅ **Yes** Embedded Kotlin HTTP server
Autonomous Wi-Fi Hosting	❌ No	✅ **Windows Hotspot** Zero router required on Win	✅ **Wi-Fi Direct** Direct or local hotspot
Dual-Screen HDMI Extend	⚡ **Browser Pop-up**	✅ **Native Dual Window** Auto-targets 2nd display	❌ No Single screen tablet display
CAMERA & PRINTING HARDWARE			
DSLR/Mirrorless (Canon, Nikon, Sony)	⚡ **WebUSB** Chrome only, limited models	✅ **Native USB PTP** Real shutter, live view, flash	✅ **USB-OTG Host** Direct PTP over USB cable
Commercial Dye-Sub Photo Printers	⚡ **Via Print Helper**	✅ **Built-in Silent** Auto-routes sizes to queues	⚡ **Network Only** If printer supports AirPrint
Bluetooth Thermal Receipt Printers	⚡ **Web Bluetooth**	⚡ **Via OS Driver**	✅ **Native RFCOMM SPP** Floyd-Steinberg dithered
INTERACTIVE EXPERIENCE & CREATIVE FX			
Virtual Assistant Voice Countdowns	✅ **Yes**	✅ **Yes**	✅ **Yes**
Roving Photoman Mode	❌ No	✅ **Yes (Built-in)** Phone to laptop auto-print	❌ No
360 Spin Video Desk (BETA)	❌ No	✅ **Full ffmpeg Suite** Slow-mo, boomerang, 40 FX	❌ No
Video Guestbook (with QR download)	✅ **Yes**	✅ **Yes**	✅ **Yes**
Pay with QR (GCash, Maya, ShopeePay)	✅ **PayMongo Live QR**	❌ Vouchers Only	❌ Vouchers Only
Lock Booth (Kiosk Protection)	✅ **Passcode Dock**	✅ **Passcode Dock**	✅ **Full Kiosk Lockdown** Keep-awake & nav-bar hide

Choose Offline Desktop when:

You run full-scale wedding or event booths with a DSLR/Mirrorless camera, studio flash strobes, dual screens (TV for guests), and a dye-sub printer (DNP, HiTi) for instant high-volume cutting.

Choose Android APK when:

You want an ultra-portable, battery-powered setup, a mobile roving tablet stand, or a trending low-cost **Thermal Receipt Photobooth** printing directly to Bluetooth receipt rolls.

Choose Online (Cloud) when:

Your venue has high-speed Wi-Fi, you want automated cashless QR payments (GCash/Maya) before guests shoot, or you run self-service iPad studio booths with cloud backup.

Choose Online + Offline Combo for:

Maximum business versatility. Handle indoor venue events with no cell service using the Desktop/Android apps, and switch to Cloud Online when hosting self-shoot studios or cashless pop-ups!

Ready to test photobooth4u? Try our 30-Minute Free Trial!

Visit and use the free Trial Mode to test your devices, camera and printer.

Discounted Launch Promo Active